

# Industry News

## In Focus

### Electronics industry hoping recovery

Globally, consumer electronics manufacturers are hoping to bounce back this year with smartphones, e-readers and smaller laptops. According to the Consumer Electronics Association, USA, the industry saw revenue fall in 2009 but it will recover in 2010.

The Indian semiconductor and electronics industry is confident of a \$400-billion revenue by 2020 (as against \$45 billion now) through concerted efforts from all stakeholders. The target is based on a market research conducted by Ernst & Young, taking into consideration the growth of key sectors like semiconductor design, high-tech manufacturing, the component industry and electronics board and systems design.

### Global computer chip sales fell 9 per cent

According to the Semiconductor Industry Association, the global sales of computer chips fell nine per cent during 2009. The annual sales fell from \$248.6 billion in 2008 to \$226.3 billion in 2009, beating earlier estimates that the global recession would drive sales down to \$219.7 billion.

The industry trade group forecasts that the sales will grow by 10.2 per cent to \$242 billion in 2010, driven by sales of computers and mobile phones. Most of this growth will come from China and India.

### Electric vehicles, tablets to drive semiconductor sales

An IMS Research report says that the semiconductor market will be driven by the automotive industry. Vehicles driven by electric motors need a large number of power semiconductor devices such as IGBTs, MOSFETs, diodes, power converters and battery management ICs.

### Aricent brings Sarin on board

Aricent has appointed ex-Vodafone CEO Arun Sarin to its board of directors. Sarin is currently a senior advisor at KKR. He is also a member of the boards of directors of Cisco Systems, Charles Schwab and Safeway Inc.

### Renesas gets new executive team

NEC Electronics and Renesas Technology have announced candidates of the executive team that will be in place following their business integration on 1st April this year. Susumu Furukawa, who is said to be well-versed in the high-tech field and has extensive experience in global business, has been appointed as the outside director of Renesas Electronics.

### New sales head at Samsung

Samsung India has roped in Anish Kapoor from Tata Teleservices as sales head of the CDMA mobile phone business. It has employed close to 300 people across divisions in areas ranging from sales and marketing and

product management to manufacturing operations.

### Sahai is Iomega's sales director

EMC India has promoted Praveen Sahai to the position of director of sales for Iomega in India and SAARC. Iomega is an EMC company and a provider of innovative storage and network security solutions for small businesses, home offices, consumers and others. Prior to this role, Sahai headed the marketing and corporate affairs department.

### Electrolube appoints export manager

Electrolube has appointed a new export manager to oversee the development of the company's business in a number of countries. Ivan Sheinam brings with him a wealth of experience, having previously worked for a global electrical insulation business, developing business in Asia and other emerging markets. Electrolube will use Ivan's expertise to further establish business within India, South Africa, Japan and the Middle East.

The demand for electric vehicles will grow steadily throughout the decade from less than 600,000 in 2008 to over 12 million in 2020.

Tablets' popularity will also prove to be a boon for semiconductor companies. According to research firm In-Stat, 50 million units of various tablets could ship in 2014. The increasing number of tablet PCs being launched in the market could provide a \$4.1-billion market opportunity for semiconductor firms by 2014.

### DRAMs to grow fastest amongst ICs

DRAMs will lead the IC market with a growth of 31 per cent this year, according to market research firm IC Insights. NAND Flash memory, 32-bit MCU

and special automotive ICs are next in the list that will contribute to overall growth in the IC market.

IC Insights says that 2010 will start a three-year reversal of the downward trend. The high wafer fab manufacturing capacity utilisation, low capital spending, improving global economy and ongoing demand for units are likely to put upward pressure on average selling prices, which would help turn the market around for many IC products beginning in 2010.

### No dip in global cellphone demand

According to a UN telecommunications agency report, the number of mobile phone users across the world will swell to five billion in 2010. Presently,